



SETTLEPATH

Complete Puppy Independence Training Guide

Clear, graded pen, room, house-departure and secure outdoor sessions. Every timed minute contains the main activity - with every timed minute focused on the main training activity.

Pen plans

Room exits

House departures

Outdoor separations

Updated 30 July 2026 - v34 | 52 plans | 949 minute cues

How the progression works

Only leave when Puppy is calm

Wait for a calm pause before stepping away, leaving the room, going through the front door or going indoors from the outdoor area.

Reward calm returns

Return quietly. Give a treat when Puppy is calm or settles quickly. Do not create an excited reunion.

Two calm results move up

Two scores of 4 or 5 on the same plan move up one plan. Two scores of 1 or 2 move down. Mixed results or a score of 3 repeat the plan.

Shorten before distress

If barking, pacing, scratching or escape behaviour increases, return calmly and make the next repetition shorter.

Use monitoring

Use video or audio for closed-door, house-departure and outdoor sessions so subtle distress is not missed.

Every minute is active training

Safety preparation belongs in the checklist. The timed rows contain only the main training actions and reward instructions.

Calmness score

1 - Escalating

Panic signs or distress keeps increasing.

2 - Frequently distressed

Repeated barking, pacing or difficulty recovering.

3 - Mixed but manageable

Some protest, but Puppy can pause, eat and recover.

4 - Mostly calm

Minor vocalisation may occur, but Puppy settles and recovers well.

5 - Calm and confident

Relaxed behaviour with no meaningful escalation.

Pen / enclosed safe area

26 graded plans. Every minute contains the main training activity. Preparation and safety checks stay outside the timed instructions.

1. **Pen 1 of 26** - Safe and Calm Beside the Pen
No full absence yet | 10 minute session
2. **Pen 2 of 26** - Small Distance Changes
No full absence yet | 10 minute session
3. **Pen 3 of 26** - Moving Around the Room
No full absence yet | 10 minute session
4. **Pen 4 of 26** - Extended Calm With You Nearby
No full absence yet | 15 minute session
5. **Pen 5 of 26** - The Distance Ladder
No full absence yet | 15 minute session
6. **Pen 6 of 26** - First Disappear-and-Reappear Practice
3 seconds out of sight | 10 minute session
7. **Pen 7 of 26** - Movement Plus First Absences
3 seconds out of sight | 15 minute session
8. **Pen 8 of 26** - Normal Household Activity
5 seconds out of sight | 10 minute session
9. **Pen 9 of 26** - Short Predictable Absences
10 seconds out of sight | 15 minute session
10. **Pen 10 of 26** - Mixed Short Absences
10 seconds out of sight | 10 minute session
11. **Pen 11 of 26** - Unpredictable Normal-Life Practice
15 seconds out of sight | 15 minute session
12. **Pen 12 of 26** - Bridge to 30 Seconds
20 seconds out of sight | 15 minute session
13. **Pen 13 of 26** - First Full 30 Seconds
30 seconds out of sight | 10 minute session
14. **Pen 14 of 26** - Steady 45-Second Absence
45 seconds out of sight | 12 minute session
15. **Pen 15 of 26** - One-Minute Independence
1 minute out of sight | 15 minute session
16. **Pen 16 of 26** - Ninety Seconds Out of Sight
1 min 30 sec out of sight | 15 minute session
17. **Pen 17 of 26** - Two-Minute Calm
2 minutes out of sight | 18 minute session
18. **Pen 18 of 26** - Three-Minute Routine
3 minutes out of sight | 20 minute session
19. **Pen 19 of 26** - Five-Minute Independence
5 minutes out of sight | 25 minute session
20. **Pen 20 of 26** - Eight-Minute Household Absence
8 minutes out of sight | 30 minute session
21. **Pen 21 of 26** - Ten-Minute Calm Alone Time
10 minutes out of sight | 30 minute session
22. **Pen 22 of 26** - Fifteen-Minute Independence
15 minutes out of sight | 35 minute session
23. **Pen 23 of 26** - Twenty-Minute Independence
20 minutes out of sight | 40 minute session
24. **Pen 24 of 26** - Thirty-Minute Independence
30 minutes out of sight | 50 minute session
25. **Pen 25 of 26** - Forty-Five-Minute Independence
45 minutes out of sight | 65 minute session
26. **Pen 26 of 26** - One-Hour Independence
60 minutes out of sight | 75 minute session

Room and house departures

18 graded plans. Every minute contains the main training activity. Preparation and safety checks stay outside the timed instructions.

1. **Room/Home 1 of 18** - Calm Together in the Chosen Room
No full absence yet | 8 minute session
2. **Room/Home 2 of 18** - First One-Second Room Exit
1 second out of sight | 10 minute session
3. **Room/Home 3 of 18** - Two-Second Room Exit
2 seconds out of sight | 10 minute session
4. **Room/Home 4 of 18** - Five-Second Room Exit
5 seconds out of sight | 10 minute session
5. **Room/Home 5 of 18** - Ten-Second Room Exit
10 seconds out of sight | 10 minute session
6. **Room/Home 6 of 18** - Thirty-Second Room Exit
30 seconds out of sight | 10 minute session
7. **Room/Home 7 of 18** - One-Minute Room Exit
1 minute out of sight | 12 minute session
8. **Room/Home 8 of 18** - Five-Minute Room Separation
5 minutes out of sight | 12 minute session
9. **Room/Home 9 of 18** - Front Door Exit for One Second
1 second out of sight | 10 minute session
10. **Room/Home 10 of 18** - Front Door Exit for Two Seconds
2 seconds out of sight | 10 minute session
11. **Room/Home 11 of 18** - Front Door Exit for Five Seconds
5 seconds out of sight | 10 minute session
12. **Room/Home 12 of 18** - Front Door Exit for Ten Seconds
10 seconds out of sight | 10 minute session
13. **Room/Home 13 of 18** - Front Door Exit for Thirty Seconds
30 seconds out of sight | 10 minute session
14. **Room/Home 14 of 18** - One Minute Outside the House
1 minute out of sight | 12 minute session
15. **Room/Home 15 of 18** - Five Minutes Home Alone
5 minutes out of sight | 12 minute session
16. **Room/Home 16 of 18** - Ten Minutes Home Alone
10 minutes out of sight | 17 minute session
17. **Room/Home 17 of 18** - Thirty Minutes Home Alone
30 minutes out of sight | 37 minute session
18. **Room/Home 18 of 18** - One Hour Home Alone
60 minutes out of sight | 67 minute session

OUTDOOR

Secure private outdoor area

8 graded plans. Every minute contains the main training activity. Preparation and safety checks stay outside the timed instructions.

1. **Outdoor 1 of 8** - Calm Together Outside

No full absence yet | 8 minute session

2. **Outdoor 2 of 8** - Step Indoors for One Second

1 second out of sight | 10 minute session

3. **Outdoor 3 of 8** - Step Indoors for Two Seconds

2 seconds out of sight | 10 minute session

4. **Outdoor 4 of 8** - Step Indoors for Five Seconds

5 seconds out of sight | 10 minute session

5. **Outdoor 5 of 8** - Step Indoors for Ten Seconds

10 seconds out of sight | 10 minute session

6. **Outdoor 6 of 8** - Step Indoors for Thirty Seconds

30 seconds out of sight | 10 minute session

7. **Outdoor 7 of 8** - One Minute Indoors

1 minute out of sight | 12 minute session

8. **Outdoor 8 of 8** - Five Minutes Indoors

5 minutes out of sight | 12 minute session

Safe and Calm Beside the Pen

No full absence yet | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy still cries regularly, but can eat and settle when you stay close.

Goal

Teach Puppy that the pen is safe even when you are present but not entertaining Puppy.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Place Puppy in the pen. Sit directly beside the pen, turned slightly sideways. Reward / adjust: Drop 1 piece of kibble for any quiet pause, sniffing, sitting or looking away from you.
Minute 2	Main activity: Remain beside the pen. Keep your hands to yourself and avoid eye contact. Reward / adjust: Reward two or three calm moments. Do not reward every second.
Minute 3	Main activity: Shift your chair or body about half a metre away. Reward / adjust: If Puppy stays quiet for 3-5 seconds, calmly place kibble into the pen.
Minute 4	Main activity: Stay at the half-metre distance. Stand up once, then sit down again. Reward / adjust: Reward after you sit if Puppy remained calm or became quiet quickly.
Minute 5	Main activity: Walk one step away and immediately return to your seat. Reward / adjust: Reward a quiet pause after the movement. Make the next repetition smaller if barking increases.
Minute 6	Main activity: Sit quietly and do something neutral, such as looking at a book or your phone. Reward / adjust: Reward one or two settled behaviours, especially lying down or engaging with Puppy's toy.
Minute 7	Main activity: Stand beside your chair for 5 seconds, then sit again. Reward / adjust: Drop kibble only while Puppy is quiet, even if the quiet pause lasts one second.
Minute 8	Main activity: Take two slow steps away, pause briefly, then return to the chair. Reward / adjust: Reward the first quiet moment after you return.

Minute	What to do
Minute 9	Main activity: Return to sitting beside the pen and allow an easy minute. Reward / adjust: Give one calm reward, then reduce food so Puppy practises settling without constant feeding.
Minute 10	Main activity: Finish with 20-30 seconds of calm beside the pen. Open the pen during a quiet pause. Reward / adjust: Release Puppy quietly. Avoid an excited greeting that makes leaving the pen the biggest reward.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Small Distance Changes

No full absence yet | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages Level 1 with brief whining rather than escalating crying.

Goal

Help Puppy cope while you move between beside the pen and a few steps away.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Start beside the pen for an easy success. Reward / adjust: Reward the first calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Move one metre away and sit down. Reward / adjust: Reward after 5-10 seconds of calm. Return to deliver the kibble, then move away again.
Minute 3	Main activity: Alternate between sitting beside the pen and one metre away. Reward / adjust: Reward calm transitions, not only lying down.
Minute 4	Main activity: Stand up, take three slow steps, and return. Reward / adjust: Reward a pause in crying. If Puppy remained quiet, wait a little longer before rewarding.
Minute 5	Main activity: Sit one to two metres away for the full minute. Reward / adjust: Give one or two pieces of kibble during calm behaviour.
Minute 6	Main activity: Walk past the pen once without stopping, then sit down farther away. Reward / adjust: Reward after you are seated if Puppy is calm.
Minute 7	Main activity: Move closer for an easier repetition, but do not interact through the bars. Reward / adjust: Reward relaxed body language or quiet engagement with a toy.
Minute 8	Main activity: Move two metres away, stand for 5-10 seconds, then return to your chair. Reward / adjust: Reward only after a quiet pause.
Minute 9	Main activity: Sit at the easier distance and ignore Puppy politely. Reward / adjust: Allow Puppy to discover that calmness does not always produce immediate attention.

Minute	What to do
Minute 10	Main activity: End beside the pen, then release during a quiet moment. Reward / adjust: Use one final piece of kibble inside the pen before opening it.
	Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating. Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Moving Around the Room

No full absence yet | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy can cope with you sitting one to two metres away.

Goal

Teach Puppy that ordinary movement does not mean Puppy must follow you.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Begin seated beside the pen for 30 seconds, then stand. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm pause before moving.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk slowly around the room while remaining visible. Reward / adjust: Approach and drop kibble after 10-15 seconds of calm.
Minute 3	Main activity: Pick up or put down one harmless household item. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the small noise or movement.
Minute 4	Main activity: Sit across the room for 20-30 seconds, then stand again. Reward / adjust: Reward only once during this minute unless Puppy is finding it difficult.
Minute 5	Main activity: Walk past the pen twice without stopping. Reward / adjust: After the second pass, reward a quiet pause.
Minute 6	Main activity: Pause near a doorway but remain fully visible. Reward / adjust: Reward if Puppy watches without escalating.
Minute 7	Main activity: Return nearer for an easier minute and sit quietly. Reward / adjust: Reward relaxed behaviour, then allow a short food-free period.
Minute 8	Main activity: Walk to the far side of the room, pause for 5 seconds, and return. Reward / adjust: Reward the first quiet moment after you return.
Minute 9	Main activity: Repeat a mixture of sitting, standing and walking. Reward / adjust: Use unpredictable rewards so Puppy is not waiting for food after every movement.

Minute	What to do
Minute 10	Main activity: Finish with an easy seated position. Release calmly. Reward / adjust: Open the pen after 1-2 seconds of quiet if possible.
	Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating. Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Extended Calm With You Nearby

No full absence yet | 15 minutes

Best for

Puppy can complete the easiest 10-minute sessions but is not ready for many disappearances.

Goal

Increase total session length without greatly increasing difficulty.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Settle Puppy after practical discomfort. Sit beside the pen. Reward / adjust: Reward the first calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Remain beside Puppy without eye contact or conversation. Reward / adjust: Reward quiet sitting, sniffing or lying down.
Minute 3	Main activity: Move half a metre away. Reward / adjust: Reward after 5 seconds of calm.
Minute 4	Main activity: Sit quietly and reduce food delivery. Reward / adjust: One calm reward at most.
Minute 5	Main activity: Stand, take one step away, and sit again. Reward / adjust: Reward a quiet pause.
Minute 6	Main activity: Move one metre away for 20-30 seconds. Reward / adjust: Return to deliver kibble, then move away again.
Minute 7	Main activity: Come closer for an easy recovery minute. Reward / adjust: Reward settled behaviour.
Minute 8	Main activity: Stand beside the pen without interacting. Reward / adjust: Reward if Puppy remains calm while you are upright.
Minute 9	Main activity: Walk two slow steps away and return. Reward / adjust: Reward after calmness.
Minute 10	Main activity: Sit one metre away and look occupied. Reward / adjust: Allow a food-free stretch.

Minute	What to do
Minute 11	Main activity: Walk once around the room while visible. Reward / adjust: Reward when you return to your chair.
Minute 12	Main activity: Remain close for a recovery minute. Reward / adjust: One small reward for calmness.
Minute 13	Main activity: Move one metre away again. Reward / adjust: Reward after a slightly longer quiet period.
Minute 14	Main activity: Sit beside the pen but continue ignoring politely. Reward / adjust: Do not make the ending obvious or exciting.
Minute 15	Main activity: Give one final calm reward and release during quietness. Reward / adjust: End neutrally.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

The Distance Ladder

No full absence yet | 15 minutes

Best for

Puppy can stay calm with you nearby for 15 minutes.

Goal

Practise several distances while keeping you visible.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Start beside the pen. Reward / adjust: Reward a calm start.
Minute 2	Main activity: Move half a metre away. Reward / adjust: Reward once.
Minute 3	Main activity: Move one metre away. Reward / adjust: Reward after 5-10 seconds of quiet.
Minute 4	Main activity: Return closer for an easy minute. Reward / adjust: Reward recovery.
Minute 5	Main activity: Move two metres away and sit. Reward / adjust: Reward once during calmness.
Minute 6	Main activity: Stand at the same distance, then sit again. Reward / adjust: Reward calm response to the change.
Minute 7	Main activity: Walk across the room and return to the two-metre position. Reward / adjust: Reward after you are seated.
Minute 8	Main activity: Move beside the pen for recovery without interacting. Reward / adjust: Minimal food.
Minute 9	Main activity: Move to the far side of the room for 10-20 seconds. Reward / adjust: Reward if manageable.
Minute 10	Main activity: Walk past the pen without stopping. Reward / adjust: Reward later, not immediately every time.

Minute	What to do
Minute 11	Main activity: Sit two metres away and remain boring. Reward / adjust: Allow a food-free settling period.
Minute 12	Main activity: Move closer, then farther again. Reward / adjust: Reward a calm transition.
Minute 13	Main activity: Walk a small circle around the room. Reward / adjust: Reward after a quiet pause.
Minute 14	Main activity: Return to an easy distance. Reward / adjust: One final calm reward.
Minute 15	Main activity: Release quietly during a calm moment. Reward / adjust: Avoid an excited greeting.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

First Disappear-and-Reappear Practice

3 seconds out of sight | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy stays manageable while you walk around the room.

Goal

Introduce extremely short moments when you are out of sight.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Start beside the pen and reward calmness. Reward / adjust: Give one easy success before any disappearance.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk around the room while remaining visible. Reward / adjust: Reward once after a calm stretch.
Minute 3	Main activity: Step partly behind the doorway for 1 second, then reappear. Reward / adjust: Return calmly and reward a quiet pause. Repeat only two or three times.
Minute 4	Main activity: Remain visible and sit one to two metres away. Reward / adjust: Use this as a recovery minute. Reward once if calm.
Minute 5	Main activity: Disappear for 1-2 seconds, reappear, then continue walking normally. Reward / adjust: Reward after quietness; do not rush directly to the pen every time.
Minute 6	Main activity: Do three easy visible movements. Reward / adjust: Reward the easiest calm repetition.
Minute 7	Main activity: Disappear for 2-3 seconds once or twice. Reward / adjust: If Puppy barks, wait for a tiny pause when safe, return, reward, and reduce the next absence.
Minute 8	Main activity: Sit nearby without interaction. Reward / adjust: Allow Puppy to settle without constant food.
Minute 9	Main activity: Mix one 1-second disappearance with visible walking. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness unpredictably.

Minute	What to do
Minute 10	Main activity: End with an easy visible minute and release calmly. Reward / adjust: Finish before Puppy becomes tired or frustrated.
Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating. Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.	

Movement Plus First Absences

3 seconds out of sight | 15 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages visible distance changes and some 1-3 second disappearances.

Goal

Blend normal movement with very brief out-of-sight repetitions.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Start beside the pen. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk slowly around the room. Reward / adjust: Reward once.
Minute 3	Main activity: Step out of sight for 1 second twice. Reward / adjust: Reward a quiet pause after returning.
Minute 4	Main activity: Sit one metre away for recovery. Reward / adjust: One reward at most.
Minute 5	Main activity: Complete a small visible household action. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement.
Minute 6	Main activity: Disappear for 2 seconds once or twice. Reward / adjust: Reduce difficulty if barking escalates.
Minute 7	Main activity: Remain visible and sit across the room. Reward / adjust: Allow a food-free stretch.
Minute 8	Main activity: Walk past the doorway but do not disappear. Reward / adjust: Reward calm response to the cue.
Minute 9	Main activity: Disappear for 2-3 seconds once. Reward / adjust: Reward quietness after returning.
Minute 10	Main activity: Come nearer for recovery without touching Puppy. Reward / adjust: Reward settled behaviour.

Minute	What to do
Minute 11	Main activity: Walk around normally while visible. Reward / adjust: One unpredictable reward.
Minute 12	Main activity: Disappear for 1 second, then later for 3 seconds. Reward / adjust: Keep both returns calm.
Minute 13	Main activity: Sit one to two metres away. Reward / adjust: Allow Puppy to settle.
Minute 14	Main activity: Finish with visible, easy movement. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm moment.
Minute 15	Main activity: Release quietly. Reward / adjust: End before overtired crying begins.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Normal Household Activity

5 seconds out of sight | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy handles 1-3 second disappearances with only mild protest.

Goal

Make pen time feel like part of ordinary life rather than a formal exercise.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Settle Puppy with a safe toy while you sit nearby. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm start.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk around and complete a tiny household task. Reward / adjust: Reward after 15-20 seconds of calm.
Minute 3	Main activity: Disappear for 2-4 seconds, then return without making eye contact. Reward / adjust: Reward a quiet pause after you are back.
Minute 4	Main activity: Sit across the room and ignore Puppy politely. Reward / adjust: One calm reward at most.
Minute 5	Main activity: Walk past the pen, touch the door handle, and remain visible. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness around the departure cue.
Minute 6	Main activity: Disappear for 3-5 seconds once or twice. Reward / adjust: Reduce to 1-2 seconds if the crying becomes sharper or more continuous.
Minute 7	Main activity: Return to visible movement and an easier distance. Reward / adjust: Reward recovery and calm engagement with the toy.
Minute 8	Main activity: Carry out another small normal task while visible. Reward / adjust: Reward after a longer quiet stretch.
Minute 9	Main activity: Mix one short disappearance with two easy visible movements. Reward / adjust: Reward only one of the three repetitions.
Minute 10	Main activity: Sit calmly near the pen, then release during quietness. Reward / adjust: End neutrally, without a big reunion.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Short Predictable Absences

10 seconds out of sight | 15 minutes

Best for

Puppy can recover quickly after 2-3 second disappearances.

Goal

Build absences of approximately 3-10 seconds while mixing in many easy repetitions.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Start close and easy. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Move around while visible. Reward / adjust: Reward once.
Minute 3	Main activity: Disappear for 3 seconds once. Reward / adjust: Reward a quiet pause after returning.
Minute 4	Main activity: Sit nearby for recovery. Reward / adjust: Minimal food.
Minute 5	Main activity: Disappear for 4-5 seconds once. Reward / adjust: If Puppy copes, reward calmly.
Minute 6	Main activity: Complete two visible movements. Reward / adjust: Reward one of them.
Minute 7	Main activity: Disappear for 3 seconds, return, and remain visible. Reward / adjust: Reward after calmness.
Minute 8	Main activity: Sit farther away for a quiet minute. Reward / adjust: Allow independent settling.
Minute 9	Main activity: Disappear for 5-7 seconds once. Reward / adjust: Halve the next absence if crying becomes continuous.
Minute 10	Main activity: Come closer for recovery. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness, not excitement.

Minute	What to do
Minute 11	Main activity: Walk past the pen and touch the door handle. Reward / adjust: Reward calm response to the cue.
Minute 12	Main activity: Disappear for 3 seconds, then later for 6-8 seconds. Reward / adjust: Keep the second repetition optional if Puppy is tired.
Minute 13	Main activity: Remain visible and boring. Reward / adjust: No reward unless needed.
Minute 14	Main activity: Finish with an easy visible minute. Reward / adjust: One final calm reward.
Minute 15	Main activity: Release during a quiet pause. Reward / adjust: End neutrally.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Mixed Short Absences

10 seconds out of sight | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy usually settles quickly after 3-5 second absences.

Goal

Build flexibility with different distances and brief absences without making every repetition harder.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Start close and easy. Reward / adjust: Reward the first calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Move around the room while visible. Reward / adjust: Reward once.
Minute 3	Main activity: Disappear for 3 seconds, then remain visible for the rest of the minute. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after returning.
Minute 4	Main activity: Sit one metre away for an easy recovery minute. Reward / adjust: Minimal food; encourage independent settling.
Minute 5	Main activity: Disappear for 5-8 seconds once. Reward / adjust: If calm, reward after returning. If Puppy cries continuously, halve the next absence.
Minute 6	Main activity: Complete two easy visible movements. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm repetition.
Minute 7	Main activity: Disappear for 3 seconds, return, then later disappear for 6-10 seconds. Reward / adjust: Keep your return calm and ordinary.
Minute 8	Main activity: Stay visible but farther away. Reward / adjust: Reward a settled posture or quiet play.
Minute 9	Main activity: Mix one easy 1-second absence and one harder 5-10 second absence. Reward / adjust: Reward only after quietness; do not increase both distance and duration at once.

Minute	What to do
Minute 10	Main activity: Finish close to the pen and release calmly. Reward / adjust: End while Puppy is still coping, not after a final difficult test.
	Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating. Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Unpredictable Normal-Life Practice

15 seconds out of sight | 15 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages 5-10 second absences without escalating.

Goal

Prevent Puppy from predicting exactly when you leave, return or reward.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Start beside the pen and then move away. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm start.
Minute 2	Main activity: Perform a normal visible task. Reward / adjust: Reward after a longer calm stretch.
Minute 3	Main activity: Disappear for 5 seconds once. Reward / adjust: Return calmly; reward quietness.
Minute 4	Main activity: Sit across the room. Reward / adjust: No reward unless Puppy settles particularly well.
Minute 5	Main activity: Walk past the pen twice without stopping. Reward / adjust: Reward later, not immediately.
Minute 6	Main activity: Disappear for 8-12 seconds once. Reward / adjust: Reduce to 3-5 seconds if needed.
Minute 7	Main activity: Return and continue the task rather than going directly to Puppy. Reward / adjust: Reward after Puppy is quiet.
Minute 8	Main activity: Sit nearby for recovery. Reward / adjust: One small reward.
Minute 9	Main activity: Disappear for 3 seconds, then remain visible. Reward / adjust: Easy repetition.
Minute 10	Main activity: Complete a quiet household task for the full minute. Reward / adjust: Reward at the end if calm.

Minute	What to do
Minute 11	Main activity: Disappear for 10-15 seconds once. Reward / adjust: Only attempt if the previous minutes were manageable.
Minute 12	Main activity: Return and sit one to two metres away. Reward / adjust: Allow Puppy to settle without immediate food.
Minute 13	Main activity: Mix visible walking with one 5-second absence. Reward / adjust: Reward unpredictably.
Minute 14	Main activity: Finish close and calm. Reward / adjust: One final reward inside the pen.
Minute 15	Main activity: Release quietly during calmness. Reward / adjust: No big reunion.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Bridge to 30 Seconds

20 seconds out of sight | 15 minutes

Best for

Puppy usually recovers quickly after 10-15 second disappearances.

Goal

Practise flexible 10-20 second absences before beginning the dedicated 30-second ladder.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Begin close and easy. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk around while visible. Reward / adjust: Reward once.
Minute 3	Main activity: Disappear for 8-10 seconds. Reward / adjust: Reward a quiet pause after returning.
Minute 4	Main activity: Sit nearby for recovery. Reward / adjust: Minimal food.
Minute 5	Main activity: Disappear for 15-20 seconds once. Reward / adjust: Return earlier if distress escalates.
Minute 6	Main activity: Stay visible and perform an easy task. Reward / adjust: Reward recovery.
Minute 7	Main activity: Disappear for 5 seconds only. Reward / adjust: This easier repetition prevents constant escalation.
Minute 8	Main activity: Sit across the room for the full minute. Reward / adjust: Allow independent settling.
Minute 9	Main activity: Disappear for approximately 15-20 seconds once. Reward / adjust: Attempt this only while Puppy remains manageable; return earlier if crying escalates.

Minute	What to do
Minute 10	Main activity: Return and remain visible. Reward / adjust: Reward after quietness.
Minute 11	Main activity: Complete two easy visible movements. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm response.
Minute 12	Main activity: Repeat an easier 8-12 second disappearance rather than adding a longer final test. Reward / adjust: End with confidence. The next stage contains the first dedicated 30-second attempt.
Minute 13	Main activity: Return and sit near the pen for recovery. Reward / adjust: Give one calm reward.
Minute 14	Main activity: Keep the final minute easy and visible. Reward / adjust: Do not add a last difficult test.
Minute 15	Main activity: Release quietly during calmness. Reward / adjust: End while Puppy is coping.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

First Full 30 Seconds

30 seconds out of sight | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy has completed the 10-20 second bridge stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal

Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 30 sec without escalating distress.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement. Reward / adjust: Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Main activity: Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause. Reward / adjust: Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Main activity: Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence. Reward / adjust: Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Main activity: Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 15 seconds and return calmly. Reward / adjust: Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Main activity: Begin the main challenge. Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. for up to 30 seconds, then return calmly within this minute. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Main activity: Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area. Reward / adjust: Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 7	Main activity: Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 10 seconds, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging. Reward / adjust: Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.

Minute	What to do
Minute 8	Main activity: Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition. Reward / adjust: Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 9	Main activity: Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention. Reward / adjust: Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 10	Main activity: Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score. Reward / adjust: End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Steady 45-Second Absence

45 seconds out of sight | 12 minutes

Best for

Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal

Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 45 sec without escalating distress.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement. Reward / adjust: Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Main activity: Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause. Reward / adjust: Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Main activity: Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence. Reward / adjust: Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Main activity: Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 22 seconds and return calmly. Reward / adjust: Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Main activity: Begin the main challenge. Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. for up to 45 seconds, then return calmly within this minute. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 7	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 8	Main activity: Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area. Reward / adjust: Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.

Minute	What to do
Minute 9	Main activity: Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 15 seconds, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging. Reward / adjust: Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 10	Main activity: Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition. Reward / adjust: Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 11	Main activity: Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention. Reward / adjust: Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 12	Main activity: Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score. Reward / adjust: End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

One-Minute Independence

1 minute out of sight | 15 minutes

Best for

Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal

Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 1 min without escalating distress.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement. Reward / adjust: Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Main activity: Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause. Reward / adjust: Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Main activity: Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence. Reward / adjust: Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Main activity: Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 30 seconds and return calmly. Reward / adjust: Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Main activity: Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 1. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 7	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.

Minute	What to do
Minute 8	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 9	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 10	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 11	Main activity: Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area. Reward / adjust: Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 12	Main activity: Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 20 seconds, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging. Reward / adjust: Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 13	Main activity: Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition. Reward / adjust: Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 14	Main activity: Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention. Reward / adjust: Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 15	Main activity: Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score. Reward / adjust: End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Ninety Seconds Out of Sight

1 min 30 sec out of sight | 15 minutes

Best for

Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal

Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 1 min 30 sec without escalating distress.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement. Reward / adjust: Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Main activity: Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause. Reward / adjust: Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Main activity: Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence. Reward / adjust: Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Main activity: Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 45 seconds and return calmly. Reward / adjust: Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Main activity: Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 2. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 2. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 7	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 8	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 9	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 10	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 11	Main activity: Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area. Reward / adjust: Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 12	Main activity: Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 30 seconds, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging. Reward / adjust: Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 13	Main activity: Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition. Reward / adjust: Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 14	Main activity: Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention. Reward / adjust: Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 15	Main activity: Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score. Reward / adjust: End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Two-Minute Calm

2 minutes out of sight | 18 minutes

Best for

Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal

Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 2 min without escalating distress.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement. Reward / adjust: Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Main activity: Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause. Reward / adjust: Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Main activity: Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence. Reward / adjust: Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Main activity: Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 1 minute and return calmly. Reward / adjust: Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Main activity: Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 2. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 2. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 7	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 8	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 9	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 10	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 11	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 12	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 13	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 14	Main activity: Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area. Reward / adjust: Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 15	Main activity: Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 40 seconds, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging. Reward / adjust: Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 16	Main activity: Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition. Reward / adjust: Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 17	Main activity: Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention. Reward / adjust: Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 18	Main activity: Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score. Reward / adjust: End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Three-Minute Routine

3 minutes out of sight | 20 minutes

Best for

Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal

Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 3 min without escalating distress.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement. Reward / adjust: Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Main activity: Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause. Reward / adjust: Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Main activity: Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence. Reward / adjust: Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Main activity: Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 1 minute 30 seconds and return calmly. Reward / adjust: Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Main activity: Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 3. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 3. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 7	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 3 of 3. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 8	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 9	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 10	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 11	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 12	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 13	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 14	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 15	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 16	Main activity: Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area. Reward / adjust: Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 17	Main activity: Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 1 minute, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging. Reward / adjust: Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 18	Main activity: Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition. Reward / adjust: Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 19	Main activity: Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention. Reward / adjust: Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 20	Main activity: Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score. Reward / adjust: End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Five-Minute Independence

5 minutes out of sight | 25 minutes

Best for

Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal

Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 5 min without escalating distress.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement. Reward / adjust: Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Main activity: Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause. Reward / adjust: Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Main activity: Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence. Reward / adjust: Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Main activity: Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 2 minutes 30 seconds and return calmly. Reward / adjust: Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Main activity: Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 5. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 5. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 7	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 3 of 5. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 8	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 4 of 5. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 9	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 5 of 5. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 10	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 11	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 12	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 13	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 14	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 15	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 16	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 17	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 18	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 19	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.

Minute	What to do
Minute 20	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 21	Main activity: Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area. Reward / adjust: Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 22	Main activity: Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 1 minute 40 seconds, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging. Reward / adjust: Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 23	Main activity: Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition. Reward / adjust: Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 24	Main activity: Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention. Reward / adjust: Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 25	Main activity: Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score. Reward / adjust: End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Eight-Minute Household Absence

8 minutes out of sight | 30 minutes

Best for

Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal

Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 8 min without escalating distress.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement. Reward / adjust: Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Main activity: Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause. Reward / adjust: Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Main activity: Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence. Reward / adjust: Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Main activity: Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 4 minutes and return calmly. Reward / adjust: Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Main activity: Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 8. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 8. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 7	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 3 of 8. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 8	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 4 of 8. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 9	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 5 of 8. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 10	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 6 of 8. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 11	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 7 of 8. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 12	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 8 of 8. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 13	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 14	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 15	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 16	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 17	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 18	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.

Minute	What to do
Minute 19	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 20	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 21	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 22	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 23	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 24	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 25	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 26	Main activity: Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area. Reward / adjust: Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 27	Main activity: Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 2 minutes 40 seconds, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging. Reward / adjust: Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 28	Main activity: Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition. Reward / adjust: Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 29	Main activity: Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention. Reward / adjust: Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 30	Main activity: Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score. Reward / adjust: End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Ten-Minute Calm Alone Time

10 minutes out of sight | 30 minutes

Best for

Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal

Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 10 min without escalating distress.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement. Reward / adjust: Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Main activity: Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause. Reward / adjust: Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Main activity: Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence. Reward / adjust: Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Main activity: Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 5 minutes and return calmly. Reward / adjust: Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Main activity: Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 10. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 10. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 7	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 3 of 10. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 8	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 4 of 10. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 9	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 5 of 10. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 10	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 6 of 10. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 11	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 7 of 10. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 12	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 8 of 10. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 13	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 9 of 10. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 14	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 10 of 10. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 15	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 16	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 17	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.

Minute	What to do
Minute 18	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 19	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 20	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 21	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 22	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 23	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 24	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 25	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 26	Main activity: Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area. Reward / adjust: Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 27	Main activity: Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 3 minutes 20 seconds, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging. Reward / adjust: Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 28	Main activity: Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition. Reward / adjust: Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 29	Main activity: Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention. Reward / adjust: Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 30	Main activity: Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score. Reward / adjust: End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Fifteen-Minute Independence

15 minutes out of sight | 35 minutes

Best for

Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal

Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 15 min without escalating distress. This is a longer future-stage attempt. Do only one full challenge attempt that day; other practices should be short, easy consolidation sessions.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement. Reward / adjust: Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Main activity: Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause. Reward / adjust: Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Main activity: Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence. Reward / adjust: Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Main activity: Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 5 minutes and return calmly. Reward / adjust: Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Main activity: Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 7	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 3 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 8	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 4 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 9	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 5 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 10	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 6 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 11	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 7 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 12	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 8 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 13	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 9 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 14	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 10 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 15	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 11 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 16	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 12 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 17	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 13 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 18	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 14 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 19	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 15 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 20	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 21	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 22	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 23	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 24	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 25	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 26	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 27	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 28	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 29	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 30	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.

Minute	What to do
Minute 31	Main activity: Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area. Reward / adjust: Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 32	Main activity: Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 5 minutes, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging. Reward / adjust: Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 33	Main activity: Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition. Reward / adjust: Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 34	Main activity: Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention. Reward / adjust: Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 35	Main activity: Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score. Reward / adjust: End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Twenty-Minute Independence

20 minutes out of sight | 40 minutes

Best for

Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal

Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 20 min without escalating distress. This is a longer future-stage attempt. Do only one full challenge attempt that day; other practices should be short, easy consolidation sessions.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement. Reward / adjust: Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Main activity: Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause. Reward / adjust: Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Main activity: Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence. Reward / adjust: Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Main activity: Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 5 minutes and return calmly. Reward / adjust: Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Main activity: Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 7	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 3 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 8	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 4 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 9	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 5 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 10	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 6 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 11	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 7 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 12	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 8 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 13	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 9 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 14	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 10 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 15	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 11 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 16	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 12 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 17	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 13 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 18	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 14 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 19	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 15 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 20	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 16 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 21	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 17 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 22	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 18 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 23	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 19 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 24	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 20 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 25	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 26	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 27	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 28	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 29	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.

Minute	What to do
Minute 30	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 31	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 32	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 33	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 34	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 35	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 36	Main activity: Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area. Reward / adjust: Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 37	Main activity: Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 5 minutes, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging. Reward / adjust: Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 38	Main activity: Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition. Reward / adjust: Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 39	Main activity: Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention. Reward / adjust: Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 40	Main activity: Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score. Reward / adjust: End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Thirty-Minute Independence

30 minutes out of sight | 50 minutes

Best for

Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal

Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 30 min without escalating distress. This is a longer future-stage attempt. Do only one full challenge attempt that day; other practices should be short, easy consolidation sessions.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement. Reward / adjust: Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Main activity: Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause. Reward / adjust: Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Main activity: Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence. Reward / adjust: Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Main activity: Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 5 minutes and return calmly. Reward / adjust: Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Main activity: Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 7	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 3 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 8	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 4 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 9	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 5 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 10	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 6 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 11	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 7 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 12	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 8 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 13	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 9 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 14	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 10 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 15	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 11 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 16	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 12 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 17	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 13 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 18	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 14 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 19	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 15 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 20	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 16 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 21	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 17 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 22	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 18 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 23	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 19 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 24	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 20 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 25	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 21 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 26	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 22 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 27	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 23 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 28	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 24 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 29	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 25 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 30	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 26 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 31	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 27 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 32	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 28 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 33	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 29 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 34	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 30 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 35	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 36	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 37	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 38	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 39	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 40	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.

Minute	What to do
Minute 41	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 42	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 43	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 44	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 45	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 46	Main activity: Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area. Reward / adjust: Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 47	Main activity: Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 5 minutes, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging. Reward / adjust: Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 48	Main activity: Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition. Reward / adjust: Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 49	Main activity: Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention. Reward / adjust: Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 50	Main activity: Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score. Reward / adjust: End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Forty-Five-Minute Independence

45 minutes out of sight | 65 minutes

Best for

Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal

Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 45 min without escalating distress. This is a longer future-stage attempt. Do only one full challenge attempt that day; other practices should be short, easy consolidation sessions.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement. Reward / adjust: Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Main activity: Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause. Reward / adjust: Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Main activity: Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence. Reward / adjust: Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Main activity: Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 5 minutes and return calmly. Reward / adjust: Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Main activity: Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 7	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 3 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 8	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 4 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 9	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 5 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 10	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 6 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 11	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 7 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 12	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 8 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 13	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 9 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 14	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 10 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 15	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 11 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 16	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 12 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 17	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 13 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 18	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 14 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 19	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 15 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 20	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 16 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 21	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 17 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 22	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 18 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 23	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 19 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 24	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 20 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 25	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 21 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 26	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 22 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 27	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 23 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 28	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 24 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 29	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 25 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 30	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 26 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 31	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 27 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 32	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 28 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 33	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 29 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 34	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 30 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 35	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 31 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 36	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 32 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 37	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 33 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 38	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 34 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 39	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 35 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 40	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 36 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 41	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 37 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 42	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 38 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 43	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 39 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 44	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 40 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 45	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 41 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 46	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 42 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 47	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 43 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 48	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 44 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 49	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 45 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 50	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.

Minute	What to do
Minute 51	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 52	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 53	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 54	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 55	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 56	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 57	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 58	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 59	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 60	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 61	Main activity: Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area. Reward / adjust: Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 62	Main activity: Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 5 minutes, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging. Reward / adjust: Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 63	Main activity: Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition. Reward / adjust: Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 64	Main activity: Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention. Reward / adjust: Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 65	Main activity: Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score. Reward / adjust: End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

One-Hour Independence

60 minutes out of sight | 75 minutes

Best for

Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal

Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 1 hr without escalating distress. This is a longer future-stage attempt. Do only one full challenge attempt that day; other practices should be short, easy consolidation sessions.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Before the timer starts

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement. Reward / adjust: Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Main activity: Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause. Reward / adjust: Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Main activity: Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence. Reward / adjust: Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Main activity: Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 5 minutes and return calmly. Reward / adjust: Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Main activity: Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 7	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 3 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 8	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 4 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 9	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 5 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 10	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 6 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 11	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 7 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 12	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 8 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 13	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 9 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 14	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 10 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 15	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 11 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 16	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 12 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 17	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 13 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 18	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 14 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 19	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 15 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 20	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 16 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 21	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 17 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 22	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 18 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 23	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 19 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 24	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 20 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 25	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 21 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 26	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 22 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 27	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 23 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 28	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 24 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 29	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 25 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 30	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 26 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 31	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 27 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 32	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 28 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 33	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 29 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 34	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 30 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 35	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 31 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 36	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 32 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 37	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 33 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 38	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 34 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 39	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 35 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 40	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 36 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 41	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 37 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 42	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 38 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 43	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 39 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 44	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 40 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 45	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 41 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 46	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 42 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 47	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 43 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 48	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 44 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 49	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 45 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 50	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 46 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 51	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 47 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 52	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 48 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 53	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 49 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 54	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 50 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 55	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 51 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 56	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 52 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 57	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 53 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 58	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 54 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 59	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 55 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 60	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 56 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 61	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 57 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	What to do
Minute 62	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 58 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 63	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 59 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 64	Main activity: Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 60 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete. Reward / adjust: Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 65	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 66	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 67	Main activity: Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period. Reward / adjust: If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 68	Main activity: Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe. Reward / adjust: Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 69	Main activity: Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again. Reward / adjust: Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 70	Main activity: Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 71	Main activity: Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area. Reward / adjust: Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 72	Main activity: Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 5 minutes, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging. Reward / adjust: Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 73	Main activity: Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition. Reward / adjust: Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 74	Main activity: Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention. Reward / adjust: Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.

Minute	What to do
Minute 75	Main activity: Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score. Reward / adjust: End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Calm Together in the Chosen Room

No full absence yet | 8 minutes

Best for

Puppy needs to learn that the chosen room is a safe, ordinary place.

Goal

Build calm behaviour before the first full room exit.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit beside Puppy in the chosen room and remain quiet for the full minute. Reward / adjust: Reward one or two naturally calm moments.
Minute 2	Main activity: Move your chair half a metre away while staying in the room. Reward / adjust: Give a treat after Puppy remains calm for a few seconds.
Minute 3	Main activity: Stand up, take two steps toward the doorway, then sit down again. Reward / adjust: Reward after you are seated and Puppy is calm.
Minute 4	Main activity: Walk to the doorway and back without leaving the room. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement.
Minute 5	Main activity: Stand in the doorway for five seconds while Puppy stays inside the room. Reward / adjust: Give a treat after you return to your seat.
Minute 6	Main activity: Step across the threshold with one foot, immediately step back in and sit down. Reward / adjust: Reward a calm response. Make the movement smaller if Puppy follows or cries.
Minute 7	Main activity: Repeat three doorway movements, keeping part of your body visible at all times. Reward / adjust: Reward the calmest repetition only.
Minute 8	Main activity: Finish by sitting one metre from Puppy while doing something neutral. Reward / adjust: Give one final treat for relaxed behaviour and end quietly.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

First One-Second Room Exit

1 second out of sight | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy can stay calm while you move around the room.

Goal

Teach Puppy that you can step out for one second and immediately return.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly with Puppy in the chosen room. Wait for Puppy to become calm before changing your position. Reward / adjust: Give one treat for a calm pause, relaxed body or quiet engagement with a toy.
Minute 2	Main activity: Move one metre away from Puppy and sit down. Stay inside the room. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after a few seconds. Do not call Puppy to you.
Minute 3	Main activity: Walk to the doorway, touch the door handle, then walk back to your seat. Reward / adjust: Reward only after Puppy is calm again.
Minute 4	Main activity: Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, leave the room for 1 second, then walk back in. Reward / adjust: Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Main activity: Sit with Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 1 second room exit. Reward / adjust: Reward the calm return. If barking increases, use a one-second exit next.
Minute 6	Main activity: Leave the room for the easier duration of 1 second. Close the door partway if Puppy remains comfortable. Reward / adjust: Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Main activity: Wait for calm, leave the room for the full 1 second, close the door, then return normally. Reward / adjust: Give the treat after calm behaviour, not during barking.
Minute 8	Main activity: Complete two repetitions: one easy 1 second exit and one 1 second exit. Reward / adjust: Pause between repetitions until Puppy is calm.

Minute	What to do
Minute 9	Main activity: Leave the room for 1 second once more. Stay quiet outside the door and return when the time is complete. Reward / adjust: Reward a calm pause after you walk back into the room.
Minute 10	Main activity: Finish with one successful 1 second room exit. Walk back in, sit down and remain neutral. Reward / adjust: Give one final treat for calmness and end while Puppy is coping well.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.



ROOM/HOME 3 OF 18

Two-Second Room Exit

2 seconds out of sight | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages one-second room exits without escalating.

Goal

Build calm, repeated two-second exits.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly with Puppy in the chosen room. Wait for Puppy to become calm before changing your position. Reward / adjust: Give one treat for a calm pause, relaxed body or quiet engagement with a toy.
Minute 2	Main activity: Move one metre away from Puppy and sit down. Stay inside the room. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after a few seconds. Do not call Puppy to you.
Minute 3	Main activity: Walk to the doorway, touch the door handle, then walk back to your seat. Reward / adjust: Reward only after Puppy is calm again.
Minute 4	Main activity: Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, leave the room for 2 seconds, then walk back in. Reward / adjust: Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Main activity: Sit with Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 2 seconds room exit. Reward / adjust: Reward the calm return. If barking increases, use a one-second exit next.
Minute 6	Main activity: Leave the room for the easier duration of 1 second. Close the door partway if Puppy remains comfortable. Reward / adjust: Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Main activity: Wait for calm, leave the room for the full 2 seconds, close the door, then return normally. Reward / adjust: Give the treat after calm behaviour, not during barking.
Minute 8	Main activity: Complete two repetitions: one easy 1 second exit and one 2 seconds exit. Reward / adjust: Pause between repetitions until Puppy is calm.

Minute	What to do
Minute 9	Main activity: Leave the room for 2 seconds once more. Stay quiet outside the door and return when the time is complete. Reward / adjust: Reward a calm pause after you walk back into the room.
Minute 10	Main activity: Finish with one successful 2 seconds room exit. Walk back in, sit down and remain neutral. Reward / adjust: Give one final treat for calmness and end while Puppy is coping well.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Five-Second Room Exit

5 seconds out of sight | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages two-second exits and calm returns.

Goal

Teach Puppy to remain calm while the door is closed for five seconds.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly with Puppy in the chosen room. Wait for Puppy to become calm before changing your position. Reward / adjust: Give one treat for a calm pause, relaxed body or quiet engagement with a toy.
Minute 2	Main activity: Move one metre away from Puppy and sit down. Stay inside the room. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after a few seconds. Do not call Puppy to you.
Minute 3	Main activity: Walk to the doorway, touch the door handle, then walk back to your seat. Reward / adjust: Reward only after Puppy is calm again.
Minute 4	Main activity: Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, leave the room for 5 seconds, then walk back in. Reward / adjust: Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Main activity: Sit with Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 5 seconds room exit. Reward / adjust: Reward the calm return. If barking increases, use a one-second exit next.
Minute 6	Main activity: Leave the room for the easier duration of 2 seconds. Close the door partway if Puppy remains comfortable. Reward / adjust: Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Main activity: Wait for calm, leave the room for the full 5 seconds, close the door, then return normally. Reward / adjust: Give the treat after calm behaviour, not during barking.
Minute 8	Main activity: Complete two repetitions: one easy 2 seconds exit and one 5 seconds exit. Reward / adjust: Pause between repetitions until Puppy is calm.

Minute	What to do
Minute 9	Main activity: Leave the room for 5 seconds once more. Stay quiet outside the door and return when the time is complete. Reward / adjust: Reward a calm pause after you walk back into the room.
Minute 10	Main activity: Finish with one successful 5 seconds room exit. Walk back in, sit down and remain neutral. Reward / adjust: Give one final treat for calmness and end while Puppy is coping well.
Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice. Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.	

Ten-Second Room Exit

10 seconds out of sight | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages five-second room exits.

Goal

Build repeated ten-second exits with calm returns.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly with Puppy in the chosen room. Wait for Puppy to become calm before changing your position. Reward / adjust: Give one treat for a calm pause, relaxed body or quiet engagement with a toy.
Minute 2	Main activity: Move one metre away from Puppy and sit down. Stay inside the room. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after a few seconds. Do not call Puppy to you.
Minute 3	Main activity: Walk to the doorway, touch the door handle, then walk back to your seat. Reward / adjust: Reward only after Puppy is calm again.
Minute 4	Main activity: Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, leave the room for 10 seconds, then walk back in. Reward / adjust: Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Main activity: Sit with Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 10 seconds room exit. Reward / adjust: Reward the calm return. If barking increases, use a one-second exit next.
Minute 6	Main activity: Leave the room for the easier duration of 5 seconds. Close the door partway if Puppy remains comfortable. Reward / adjust: Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Main activity: Wait for calm, leave the room for the full 10 seconds, close the door, then return normally. Reward / adjust: Give the treat after calm behaviour, not during barking.
Minute 8	Main activity: Complete two repetitions: one easy 5 seconds exit and one 10 seconds exit. Reward / adjust: Pause between repetitions until Puppy is calm.

Minute	What to do
Minute 9	Main activity: Leave the room for 10 seconds once more. Stay quiet outside the door and return when the time is complete. Reward / adjust: Reward a calm pause after you walk back into the room.
Minute 10	Main activity: Finish with one successful 10 seconds room exit. Walk back in, sit down and remain neutral. Reward / adjust: Give one final treat for calmness and end while Puppy is coping well.
Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice. Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.	

Thirty-Second Room Exit

30 seconds out of sight | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages ten-second room exits.

Goal

Progress gradually to a calm thirty-second room separation.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly with Puppy in the chosen room and begin only after a calm pause. Reward / adjust: Reward the first calm moment.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk to the doorway and back twice while Puppy remains in the room. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the second movement.
Minute 3	Main activity: Leave the room for 5 seconds with the door open, then return. Reward / adjust: Give a treat after calm behaviour.
Minute 4	Main activity: Leave the room for 10 seconds and close the door partway. Reward / adjust: Return before worry increases and reward calmness.
Minute 5	Main activity: Leave the room for 15 seconds with the door closed. Reward / adjust: Give a treat after a quiet return.
Minute 6	Main activity: Wait for Puppy to become calm, then leave the room for the full 30 seconds. Reward / adjust: Return normally and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Main activity: Stay in the room with Puppy for the full minute as an easy recovery. Reward / adjust: Reward relaxed behaviour once.
Minute 8	Main activity: Leave for 20 seconds, return and sit down without excitement. Reward / adjust: Reward after Puppy settles.
Minute 9	Main activity: Repeat the full 30-second room exit with the door closed. Reward / adjust: Use a camera if Puppy cannot be heard clearly. Reward calmness after return.
Minute 10	Main activity: Finish with one easy 5-second exit and a calm return. Reward / adjust: Give one final treat and end the session.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

One-Minute Room Exit

1 minute out of sight | 12 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages thirty seconds behind a closed door.

Goal

Build one full minute of calm room separation.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly with Puppy in the room until Puppy is calm. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk to the doorway, step out for 5 seconds and return. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after you return.
Minute 3	Main activity: Leave the room for 10 seconds with the door closed. Reward / adjust: Return before distress and reward calmness.
Minute 4	Main activity: Leave the room for 30 seconds while monitoring Puppy. Reward / adjust: Reward calm behaviour after return.
Minute 5	Main activity: Sit inside the room for an easy recovery minute. Reward / adjust: Give one treat for settled behaviour.
Minute 6	Main activity: Wait for calm, say the cue once and leave the room for one full minute. Reward / adjust: Use the monitor. Return early if distress begins to build.
Minute 7	Main activity: Walk back in calmly, sit down and wait for Puppy to settle. Reward / adjust: Give a treat only after Puppy is calm.
Minute 8	Main activity: Leave the room for 20 seconds and return normally. Reward / adjust: Reward the quiet return.
Minute 9	Main activity: Repeat one full one-minute room exit if Puppy remains comfortable. Reward / adjust: Return calmly and reward after a calm pause.
Minute 10	Main activity: Stay inside the room for a recovery minute without entertaining Puppy. Reward / adjust: Reward relaxed independent behaviour.

Minute	What to do
Minute 11	Main activity: Complete one easy 10-second exit with the door closed. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness.
Minute 12	Main activity: Finish with one 5-second room exit and a quiet return. Reward / adjust: End while Puppy is still successful.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Five-Minute Room Separation

5 minutes out of sight | 12 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages one minute in another room.

Goal

Build a monitored five-minute separation in the chosen room.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly near Puppy. Begin only when Puppy is calm. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk to the room doorway and return to your seat. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement.
Minute 3	Main activity: Leave the room for 5 seconds with the door closed, then return. Reward / adjust: Reward after Puppy is calm.
Minute 4	Main activity: Leave the room for 10 seconds and return normally. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness.
Minute 5	Main activity: Leave the room for 30 seconds, then return and sit quietly. Reward / adjust: Reward after Puppy settles.
Minute 6	Main activity: Wait for calm, say the cue once, leave the room and close the door. Begin the 5 minutes challenge. This is challenge minute 1 of 5. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 7	Main activity: Remain outside the room. This is challenge minute 2 of 5. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 8	Main activity: Remain outside the room. This is challenge minute 3 of 5. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.

Minute	What to do
Minute 9	Main activity: Remain outside the room. This is challenge minute 4 of 5. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 10	Main activity: Remain outside the room. This is challenge minute 5 of 5. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Near the end of this minute, walk back into the room calmly. Reward / adjust: After returning, wait for calm and give one quiet treat.
Minute 11	Main activity: Sit quietly near Puppy for a recovery minute without creating an excited reunion. Reward / adjust: Reward calm, settled behaviour once.
Minute 12	Main activity: Complete one easy 10-second room exit and return normally. Reward / adjust: Give one final treat for calmness and end the session.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Front Door Exit for One Second

1 second out of sight | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy is calm with room exits and needs the first true house departure.

Goal

Teach Puppy that the front door closes for one second and you return.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly near Puppy in the chosen safe area. Begin only after Puppy is calm. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk to the front door, touch the handle, then walk back to Puppy. Reward / adjust: Reward after Puppy remains calm.
Minute 3	Main activity: Open and close the front door while staying inside the house. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the door movement.
Minute 4	Main activity: Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, step outside for 1 second, close the door and walk back in. Reward / adjust: Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Main activity: Sit near Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 1 second front-door exit. Reward / adjust: Reward the calm return.
Minute 6	Main activity: Step outside for the easier duration of 1 second, close the door, then return normally. Reward / adjust: Reward before worry grows.
Minute 7	Main activity: Wait for calm and repeat the full 1 second house exit. Reward / adjust: Give a treat after calm behaviour, not during barking.
Minute 8	Main activity: Complete two repetitions: one easy 1 second exit and one 1 second exit. Reward / adjust: Pause until Puppy is calm between repetitions.
Minute 9	Main activity: Step outside for 1 second and remain quiet on the other side of the door. Reward / adjust: Return normally and reward a calm pause.

Minute	What to do
Minute 10	Main activity: Finish with one successful 1 second front-door exit. Reward / adjust: Walk back in, sit down and give one final treat for calmness.
	Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice. Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Front Door Exit for Two Seconds

2 seconds out of sight | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages one-second front-door exits.

Goal

Build calm two-second house departures.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly near Puppy in the chosen safe area. Begin only after Puppy is calm. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk to the front door, touch the handle, then walk back to Puppy. Reward / adjust: Reward after Puppy remains calm.
Minute 3	Main activity: Open and close the front door while staying inside the house. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the door movement.
Minute 4	Main activity: Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, step outside for 2 seconds, close the door and walk back in. Reward / adjust: Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Main activity: Sit near Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 2 seconds front-door exit. Reward / adjust: Reward the calm return.
Minute 6	Main activity: Step outside for the easier duration of 1 second, close the door, then return normally. Reward / adjust: Reward before worry grows.
Minute 7	Main activity: Wait for calm and repeat the full 2 seconds house exit. Reward / adjust: Give a treat after calm behaviour, not during barking.
Minute 8	Main activity: Complete two repetitions: one easy 1 second exit and one 2 seconds exit. Reward / adjust: Pause until Puppy is calm between repetitions.
Minute 9	Main activity: Step outside for 2 seconds and remain quiet on the other side of the door. Reward / adjust: Return normally and reward a calm pause.

Minute	What to do
Minute 10	Main activity: Finish with one successful 2 seconds front-door exit. Reward / adjust: Walk back in, sit down and give one final treat for calmness.
	Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice. Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Front Door Exit for Five Seconds

5 seconds out of sight | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages two-second front-door exits.

Goal

Build repeated five-second departures from the house.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly near Puppy in the chosen safe area. Begin only after Puppy is calm. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk to the front door, touch the handle, then walk back to Puppy. Reward / adjust: Reward after Puppy remains calm.
Minute 3	Main activity: Open and close the front door while staying inside the house. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the door movement.
Minute 4	Main activity: Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, step outside for 5 seconds, close the door and walk back in. Reward / adjust: Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Main activity: Sit near Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 5 seconds front-door exit. Reward / adjust: Reward the calm return.
Minute 6	Main activity: Step outside for the easier duration of 2 seconds, close the door, then return normally. Reward / adjust: Reward before worry grows.
Minute 7	Main activity: Wait for calm and repeat the full 5 seconds house exit. Reward / adjust: Give a treat after calm behaviour, not during barking.
Minute 8	Main activity: Complete two repetitions: one easy 2 seconds exit and one 5 seconds exit. Reward / adjust: Pause until Puppy is calm between repetitions.
Minute 9	Main activity: Step outside for 5 seconds and remain quiet on the other side of the door. Reward / adjust: Return normally and reward a calm pause.

Minute	What to do
Minute 10	Main activity: Finish with one successful 5 seconds front-door exit. Reward / adjust: Walk back in, sit down and give one final treat for calmness.
	Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice. Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Front Door Exit for Ten Seconds

10 seconds out of sight | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages five-second front-door exits.

Goal

Build repeated ten-second house departures.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly near Puppy in the chosen safe area. Begin only after Puppy is calm. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk to the front door, touch the handle, then walk back to Puppy. Reward / adjust: Reward after Puppy remains calm.
Minute 3	Main activity: Open and close the front door while staying inside the house. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the door movement.
Minute 4	Main activity: Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, step outside for 10 seconds, close the door and walk back in. Reward / adjust: Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Main activity: Sit near Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 10 seconds front-door exit. Reward / adjust: Reward the calm return.
Minute 6	Main activity: Step outside for the easier duration of 5 seconds, close the door, then return normally. Reward / adjust: Reward before worry grows.
Minute 7	Main activity: Wait for calm and repeat the full 10 seconds house exit. Reward / adjust: Give a treat after calm behaviour, not during barking.
Minute 8	Main activity: Complete two repetitions: one easy 5 seconds exit and one 10 seconds exit. Reward / adjust: Pause until Puppy is calm between repetitions.
Minute 9	Main activity: Step outside for 10 seconds and remain quiet on the other side of the door. Reward / adjust: Return normally and reward a calm pause.

Minute	What to do
Minute 10	Main activity: Finish with one successful 10 seconds front-door exit. Reward / adjust: Walk back in, sit down and give one final treat for calmness.
	Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice. Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Front Door Exit for Thirty Seconds

30 seconds out of sight | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages ten-second front-door exits.

Goal

Progress gradually to thirty seconds outside the house.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly near Puppy and begin only after a calm pause. Reward / adjust: Reward the calm start.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk to the front door, touch the handle and return. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness.
Minute 3	Main activity: Open and close the front door while staying inside. Reward / adjust: Reward after Puppy stays calm.
Minute 4	Main activity: Step outside for 5 seconds, close the door and return. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after return.
Minute 5	Main activity: Step outside for 10 seconds and return normally. Reward / adjust: Reward a quiet pause.
Minute 6	Main activity: Step outside for 15 seconds while monitoring Puppy. Reward / adjust: Return before worry increases and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Main activity: Wait for calm, then complete the full 30-second house exit. Reward / adjust: Return normally and reward after Puppy is calm.
Minute 8	Main activity: Stay inside with Puppy for a recovery minute. Reward / adjust: Reward settled behaviour once.
Minute 9	Main activity: Repeat one full 30-second front-door exit. Reward / adjust: Use the monitor and return calmly.
Minute 10	Main activity: Finish with one easy 5-second exit. Reward / adjust: Give one final calm reward and end.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

One Minute Outside the House

1 minute out of sight | 12 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages thirty seconds outside the house.

Goal

Build one full minute of calm home-alone practice.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly near Puppy until Puppy is calm. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk to the front door and return. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness.
Minute 3	Main activity: Open and close the front door while staying inside. Reward / adjust: Reward after calm behaviour.
Minute 4	Main activity: Step outside for 10 seconds and return normally. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness.
Minute 5	Main activity: Step outside for 30 seconds while monitoring Puppy. Reward / adjust: Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 6	Main activity: Wait for calm, say the cue once and step outside for one full minute. Reward / adjust: Use the monitor. Return early if distress escalates.
Minute 7	Main activity: Walk back in calmly, sit down and wait for Puppy to settle. Reward / adjust: Give a treat only after calmness.
Minute 8	Main activity: Complete one 20-second exit. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after return.
Minute 9	Main activity: Repeat one full one-minute house exit if Puppy remains comfortable. Reward / adjust: Return calmly and reward after a quiet pause.
Minute 10	Main activity: Remain inside for an easy recovery minute. Reward / adjust: Reward relaxed independent behaviour.

Minute	What to do
Minute 11	Main activity: Complete one 10-second exit. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness.
Minute 12	Main activity: Finish with one 5-second exit and a quiet return. Reward / adjust: End while Puppy is successful.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Five Minutes Home Alone

5 minutes out of sight | 12 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages one minute outside the house.

Goal

Build a monitored five-minute home departure.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly near Puppy. Begin only when Puppy is calm. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk to the front door, touch the handle, then return to Puppy. Reward / adjust: Reward after Puppy remains calm.
Minute 3	Main activity: Open and close the front door while staying inside. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the door movement.
Minute 4	Main activity: Step outside for 5 seconds, close the door, then return. Reward / adjust: Reward a calm return.
Minute 5	Main activity: Step outside for 30 seconds, return and sit down quietly. Reward / adjust: Reward after Puppy settles.
Minute 6	Main activity: Wait for calm, say the cue once, step through the front door and close it. Begin the 5 minutes challenge. This is challenge minute 1 of 5. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 7	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 2 of 5. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 8	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 3 of 5. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.

Minute	What to do
Minute 9	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 4 of 5. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 10	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 5 of 5. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Near the end of this minute, walk back into the house calmly. Reward / adjust: After returning, wait for calm and give one quiet treat.
Minute 11	Main activity: Sit quietly near Puppy for a recovery minute without creating an excited reunion. Reward / adjust: Reward calm, settled behaviour once.
Minute 12	Main activity: Complete one easy 10-second front-door exit and return normally. Reward / adjust: Give one final treat for calmness and end the session.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Ten Minutes Home Alone

10 minutes out of sight | 17 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages five minutes home alone.

Goal

Build a monitored ten-minute home departure.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly near Puppy. Begin only when Puppy is calm. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk to the front door, touch the handle, then return to Puppy. Reward / adjust: Reward after Puppy remains calm.
Minute 3	Main activity: Open and close the front door while staying inside. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the door movement.
Minute 4	Main activity: Step outside for 5 seconds, close the door, then return. Reward / adjust: Reward a calm return.
Minute 5	Main activity: Step outside for 30 seconds, return and sit down quietly. Reward / adjust: Reward after Puppy settles.
Minute 6	Main activity: Wait for calm, say the cue once, step through the front door and close it. Begin the 10 minutes challenge. This is challenge minute 1 of 10. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 7	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 2 of 10. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 8	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 3 of 10. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.

Minute	What to do
Minute 9	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 4 of 10. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 10	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 5 of 10. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 11	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 6 of 10. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 12	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 7 of 10. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 13	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 8 of 10. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 14	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 9 of 10. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 15	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 10 of 10. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Near the end of this minute, walk back into the house calmly. Reward / adjust: After returning, wait for calm and give one quiet treat.
Minute 16	Main activity: Sit quietly near Puppy for a recovery minute without creating an excited reunion. Reward / adjust: Reward calm, settled behaviour once.
Minute 17	Main activity: Complete one easy 10-second front-door exit and return normally. Reward / adjust: Give one final treat for calmness and end the session.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Thirty Minutes Home Alone

30 minutes out of sight | 37 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages ten minutes home alone without distress.

Goal

Build a future thirty-minute home departure one minute at a time.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly near Puppy. Begin only when Puppy is calm. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk to the front door, touch the handle, then return to Puppy. Reward / adjust: Reward after Puppy remains calm.
Minute 3	Main activity: Open and close the front door while staying inside. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the door movement.
Minute 4	Main activity: Step outside for 5 seconds, close the door, then return. Reward / adjust: Reward a calm return.
Minute 5	Main activity: Step outside for 30 seconds, return and sit down quietly. Reward / adjust: Reward after Puppy settles.
Minute 6	Main activity: Wait for calm, say the cue once, step through the front door and close it. Begin the 30 minutes challenge. This is challenge minute 1 of 30. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 7	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 2 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 8	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 3 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.

Minute	What to do
Minute 9	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 4 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 10	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 5 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 11	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 6 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 12	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 7 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 13	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 8 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 14	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 9 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 15	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 10 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 16	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 11 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 17	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 12 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 18	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 13 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 19	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 14 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.

Minute	What to do
Minute 20	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 15 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 21	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 16 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 22	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 17 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 23	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 18 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 24	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 19 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 25	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 20 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 26	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 21 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 27	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 22 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 28	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 23 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 29	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 24 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 30	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 25 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.

Minute	What to do
Minute 31	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 26 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 32	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 27 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 33	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 28 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 34	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 29 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 35	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 30 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Near the end of this minute, walk back into the house calmly. Reward / adjust: After returning, wait for calm and give one quiet treat.
Minute 36	Main activity: Sit quietly near Puppy for a recovery minute without creating an excited reunion. Reward / adjust: Reward calm, settled behaviour once.
Minute 37	Main activity: Complete one easy 10-second front-door exit and return normally. Reward / adjust: Give one final treat for calmness and end the session.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

One Hour Home Alone

60 minutes out of sight | 67 minutes

Best for

Puppy is older and consistently comfortable with thirty-minute departures.

Goal

Build a future one-hour home departure with continuous monitoring.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly near Puppy. Begin only when Puppy is calm. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk to the front door, touch the handle, then return to Puppy. Reward / adjust: Reward after Puppy remains calm.
Minute 3	Main activity: Open and close the front door while staying inside. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the door movement.
Minute 4	Main activity: Step outside for 5 seconds, close the door, then return. Reward / adjust: Reward a calm return.
Minute 5	Main activity: Step outside for 30 seconds, return and sit down quietly. Reward / adjust: Reward after Puppy settles.
Minute 6	Main activity: Wait for calm, say the cue once, step through the front door and close it. Begin the 60 minutes challenge. This is challenge minute 1 of 60. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 7	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 2 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 8	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 3 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.

Minute	What to do
Minute 9	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 4 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 10	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 5 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 11	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 6 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 12	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 7 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 13	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 8 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 14	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 9 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 15	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 10 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 16	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 11 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 17	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 12 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 18	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 13 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 19	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 14 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.

Minute	What to do
Minute 20	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 15 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 21	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 16 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 22	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 17 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 23	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 18 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 24	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 19 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 25	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 20 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 26	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 21 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 27	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 22 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 28	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 23 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 29	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 24 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 30	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 25 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.

Minute	What to do
Minute 31	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 26 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 32	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 27 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 33	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 28 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 34	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 29 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 35	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 30 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 36	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 31 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 37	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 32 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 38	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 33 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 39	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 34 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 40	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 35 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 41	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 36 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.

Minute	What to do
Minute 42	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 37 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 43	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 38 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 44	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 39 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 45	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 40 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 46	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 41 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 47	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 42 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 48	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 43 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 49	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 44 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 50	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 45 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 51	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 46 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 52	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 47 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.

Minute	What to do
Minute 53	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 48 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 54	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 49 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 55	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 50 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 56	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 51 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 57	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 52 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 58	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 53 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 59	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 54 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 60	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 55 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 61	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 56 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 62	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 57 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 63	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 58 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.

Minute	What to do
Minute 64	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 59 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 65	Main activity: Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 60 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Near the end of this minute, walk back into the house calmly. Reward / adjust: After returning, wait for calm and give one quiet treat.
Minute 66	Main activity: Sit quietly near Puppy for a recovery minute without creating an excited reunion. Reward / adjust: Reward calm, settled behaviour once.
Minute 67	Main activity: Complete one easy 10-second front-door exit and return normally. Reward / adjust: Give one final treat for calmness and end the session.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.



OUTDOOR 1 OF 8

Calm Together Outside

No full absence yet | 8 minutes

Best for

Puppy needs to feel calm in the secure outdoor area while you remain outside.

Goal

Build calm outdoor behaviour before the first full indoor disappearance.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide suitable shade, water and comfortable weather conditions
- Prepare small treats and use a camera or audio monitor

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly outside with Puppy and wait for a calm pause. Reward / adjust: Reward relaxed behaviour once.
Minute 2	Main activity: Move one metre away from Puppy while remaining outside. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after a few seconds.
Minute 3	Main activity: Walk to the indoor door, touch the handle and walk back to Puppy. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement.
Minute 4	Main activity: Open and close the indoor door while remaining outside with Puppy. Reward / adjust: Reward a calm response.
Minute 5	Main activity: Stand in the doorway for five seconds while Puppy remains outside. Reward / adjust: Return to Puppy and reward calmness.
Minute 6	Main activity: Step one foot indoors while keeping the door open and your body visible. Reward / adjust: Step back outside and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Main activity: Repeat three doorway movements without fully disappearing. Reward / adjust: Reward the calmest repetition.
Minute 8	Main activity: Finish by sitting two metres away from Puppy outside. Reward / adjust: Give one final treat for relaxed behaviour and end quietly.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and water. Monitor Puppy and stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts or distress increases.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan.



OUTDOOR 2 OF 8

Step Indoors for One Second

1 second out of sight | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy remains calm while you move toward the indoor door.

Goal

Teach Puppy that you can go indoors for one second and return outside.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide suitable shade, water and comfortable weather conditions
- Prepare small treats and use a camera or audio monitor

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly outside with Puppy. Begin only when Puppy is calm. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk to the indoor door and back while Puppy remains outside. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement.
Minute 3	Main activity: Step indoors but keep the door open and part of your body visible, then step back outside. Reward / adjust: Reward a calm response.
Minute 4	Main activity: Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, go indoors for 1 second, close the door and return outside. Reward / adjust: Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Main activity: Sit outside with Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 1 second indoor absence. Reward / adjust: Reward the calm return.
Minute 6	Main activity: Go indoors for the easier duration of 1 second and close the door. Reward / adjust: Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Main activity: Wait for calm, then go indoors for the full 1 second. Reward / adjust: Return normally and give the treat after calm behaviour.
Minute 8	Main activity: Complete two repetitions: one easy 1 second absence and one 1 second absence. Reward / adjust: Pause outside with Puppy until calm between repetitions.
Minute 9	Main activity: Go indoors for 1 second once more and remain quiet inside. Reward / adjust: Return outside normally and reward a calm pause.

Minute	What to do
Minute 10	Main activity: Finish with one successful 1 second indoor absence. Reward / adjust: Sit outside, give one final calm reward and end the session.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and water. Monitor Puppy and stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts or distress increases.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan.



OUTDOOR 3 OF 8

Step Indoors for Two Seconds

2 seconds out of sight | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages one-second indoor disappearances.

Goal

Build repeated two-second outdoor separations.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide suitable shade, water and comfortable weather conditions
- Prepare small treats and use a camera or audio monitor

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly outside with Puppy. Begin only when Puppy is calm. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk to the indoor door and back while Puppy remains outside. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement.
Minute 3	Main activity: Step indoors but keep the door open and part of your body visible, then step back outside. Reward / adjust: Reward a calm response.
Minute 4	Main activity: Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, go indoors for 2 seconds, close the door and return outside. Reward / adjust: Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Main activity: Sit outside with Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 2 seconds indoor absence. Reward / adjust: Reward the calm return.
Minute 6	Main activity: Go indoors for the easier duration of 1 second and close the door. Reward / adjust: Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Main activity: Wait for calm, then go indoors for the full 2 seconds. Reward / adjust: Return normally and give the treat after calm behaviour.
Minute 8	Main activity: Complete two repetitions: one easy 1 second absence and one 2 seconds absence. Reward / adjust: Pause outside with Puppy until calm between repetitions.
Minute 9	Main activity: Go indoors for 2 seconds once more and remain quiet inside. Reward / adjust: Return outside normally and reward a calm pause.

Minute	What to do
Minute 10	Main activity: Finish with one successful 2 seconds indoor absence. Reward / adjust: Sit outside, give one final calm reward and end the session.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and water. Monitor Puppy and stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts or distress increases.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan.



OUTDOOR 4 OF 8

Step Indoors for Five Seconds

5 seconds out of sight | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages two-second indoor disappearances.

Goal

Build repeated five-second outdoor separations.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide suitable shade, water and comfortable weather conditions
- Prepare small treats and use a camera or audio monitor

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly outside with Puppy. Begin only when Puppy is calm. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk to the indoor door and back while Puppy remains outside. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement.
Minute 3	Main activity: Step indoors but keep the door open and part of your body visible, then step back outside. Reward / adjust: Reward a calm response.
Minute 4	Main activity: Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, go indoors for 5 seconds, close the door and return outside. Reward / adjust: Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Main activity: Sit outside with Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 5 seconds indoor absence. Reward / adjust: Reward the calm return.
Minute 6	Main activity: Go indoors for the easier duration of 2 seconds and close the door. Reward / adjust: Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Main activity: Wait for calm, then go indoors for the full 5 seconds. Reward / adjust: Return normally and give the treat after calm behaviour.
Minute 8	Main activity: Complete two repetitions: one easy 2 seconds absence and one 5 seconds absence. Reward / adjust: Pause outside with Puppy until calm between repetitions.
Minute 9	Main activity: Go indoors for 5 seconds once more and remain quiet inside. Reward / adjust: Return outside normally and reward a calm pause.

Minute	What to do
Minute 10	Main activity: Finish with one successful 5 seconds indoor absence. Reward / adjust: Sit outside, give one final calm reward and end the session.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and water. Monitor Puppy and stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts or distress increases.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan.



OUTDOOR 5 OF 8

Step Indoors for Ten Seconds

10 seconds out of sight | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages five-second indoor disappearances.

Goal

Build repeated ten-second outdoor separations.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide suitable shade, water and comfortable weather conditions
- Prepare small treats and use a camera or audio monitor

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly outside with Puppy. Begin only when Puppy is calm. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk to the indoor door and back while Puppy remains outside. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness after the movement.
Minute 3	Main activity: Step indoors but keep the door open and part of your body visible, then step back outside. Reward / adjust: Reward a calm response.
Minute 4	Main activity: Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, go indoors for 10 seconds, close the door and return outside. Reward / adjust: Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Main activity: Sit outside with Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 10 seconds indoor absence. Reward / adjust: Reward the calm return.
Minute 6	Main activity: Go indoors for the easier duration of 5 seconds and close the door. Reward / adjust: Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Main activity: Wait for calm, then go indoors for the full 10 seconds. Reward / adjust: Return normally and give the treat after calm behaviour.
Minute 8	Main activity: Complete two repetitions: one easy 5 seconds absence and one 10 seconds absence. Reward / adjust: Pause outside with Puppy until calm between repetitions.
Minute 9	Main activity: Go indoors for 10 seconds once more and remain quiet inside. Reward / adjust: Return outside normally and reward a calm pause.

Minute	What to do
Minute 10	Main activity: Finish with one successful 10 seconds indoor absence. Reward / adjust: Sit outside, give one final calm reward and end the session.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and water. Monitor Puppy and stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts or distress increases.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan.



OUTDOOR 6 OF 8

Step Indoors for Thirty Seconds

30 seconds out of sight | 10 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages ten-second indoor disappearances.

Goal

Progress gradually to thirty seconds outside without you.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide suitable shade, water and comfortable weather conditions
- Prepare small treats and use a camera or audio monitor

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly outside with Puppy and begin only after a calm pause. Reward / adjust: Reward the calm start.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk to the indoor door and back. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness.
Minute 3	Main activity: Go indoors for 5 seconds, close the door and return outside. Reward / adjust: Reward after Puppy is calm.
Minute 4	Main activity: Go indoors for 10 seconds and return normally. Reward / adjust: Reward a quiet pause.
Minute 5	Main activity: Go indoors for 15 seconds while monitoring Puppy. Reward / adjust: Return before worry increases and reward calmness.
Minute 6	Main activity: Wait for calm, then go indoors for the full 30 seconds. Reward / adjust: Return outside normally and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Main activity: Sit outside with Puppy for a recovery minute. Reward / adjust: Reward relaxed behaviour once.
Minute 8	Main activity: Go indoors for 20 seconds and return. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness.
Minute 9	Main activity: Repeat one full 30-second indoor absence. Reward / adjust: Use the monitor and return calmly.
Minute 10	Main activity: Finish with one easy 5-second indoor absence. Reward / adjust: Give one final treat for calmness and end.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and water. Monitor Puppy and stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts or distress increases.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan.



OUTDOOR 7 OF 8

One Minute Indoors

1 minute out of sight | 12 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages thirty seconds outside without you.

Goal

Build one full minute of calm outdoor separation.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide suitable shade, water and comfortable weather conditions
- Prepare small treats and use a camera or audio monitor

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly outside with Puppy until Puppy is calm. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Walk to the indoor door and return. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness.
Minute 3	Main activity: Go indoors for 5 seconds and return outside. Reward / adjust: Reward a calm response.
Minute 4	Main activity: Go indoors for 10 seconds and close the door. Reward / adjust: Return before distress and reward calmness.
Minute 5	Main activity: Go indoors for 30 seconds while monitoring Puppy. Reward / adjust: Return calmly and reward after a quiet pause.
Minute 6	Main activity: Wait for calm, say the cue once and go indoors for one full minute. Reward / adjust: Use the monitor. Return early if distress escalates.
Minute 7	Main activity: Return outside calmly and sit down near Puppy. Reward / adjust: Give a treat only after calmness.
Minute 8	Main activity: Go indoors for 20 seconds and return normally. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness.
Minute 9	Main activity: Repeat one full one-minute indoor absence if Puppy remains comfortable. Reward / adjust: Return calmly and reward a quiet pause.
Minute 10	Main activity: Stay outside with Puppy for an easy recovery minute. Reward / adjust: Reward relaxed independent behaviour.

Minute	What to do
Minute 11	Main activity: Complete one 10-second indoor absence. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness.
Minute 12	Main activity: Finish with one 5-second indoor absence and a quiet return. Reward / adjust: End while Puppy is successful.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and water. Monitor Puppy and stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts or distress increases.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan.



OUTDOOR 8 OF 8

Five Minutes Indoors

5 minutes out of sight | 12 minutes

Best for

Puppy manages one minute outside without you.

Goal

Build a monitored five-minute outdoor separation.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Before the timer starts

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide suitable shade, water and comfortable weather conditions
- Prepare small treats and use a camera or audio monitor

Minute-by-minute main activities

Minute	What to do
Minute 1	Main activity: Sit quietly outside with Puppy until Puppy is calm. Reward / adjust: Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Main activity: Go indoors for 5 seconds and return outside. Reward / adjust: Reward calmness.
Minute 3	Main activity: Go indoors for 15 seconds with the door closed. Reward / adjust: Return calmly and reward after a quiet pause.
Minute 4	Main activity: Go indoors for 30 seconds while monitoring Puppy. Reward / adjust: Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 5	Main activity: Go indoors for one minute and return outside. Reward / adjust: Reward after Puppy is calm.
Minute 6	Main activity: Wait for calm, say the cue once and go indoors. Begin the five-minute outdoor challenge. This is challenge minute 1 of 5. Reward / adjust: Use the monitor and return early if distress escalates.
Minute 7	Main activity: Remain indoors. This is challenge minute 2 of 5. Check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Reward / adjust: Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable.
Minute 8	Main activity: Remain indoors. This is challenge minute 3 of 5. Reward / adjust: Watch for pacing, repeated barking, scratching at the exterior door or escape attempts.
Minute 9	Main activity: Remain indoors. This is challenge minute 4 of 5. Reward / adjust: Return early if distress begins to build.

Minute	What to do
Minute 10	Main activity: Remain indoors for challenge minute 5 of 5, then return outside calmly near the end of the minute. Reward / adjust: Wait for calm and give one quiet treat.
Minute 11	Main activity: Sit outside with Puppy for an easy recovery minute. Reward / adjust: Reward relaxed behaviour once.
Minute 12	Main activity: Finish with one easy 10-second indoor absence. Reward / adjust: Return outside, reward calmness and end the session.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and water. Monitor Puppy and stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts or distress increases.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan.

Guidance sources included in the app

1. Dogs Trust - How to help your dog get used to spending time alone

Build time apart gradually, pair it with positive enrichment, monitor the dog and shorten the next attempt if anxiety appears.

<https://www.dogstrust.org.uk/dog-advice/training/home/time-alone>

2. Dogs Trust - Separation anxiety: leaving the room

Practise brief out-of-sight periods, increase time gradually and use a camera to check that the dog remains relaxed.

<https://www.dogstrust.org.uk/dog-advice/training/unwanted-behaviours/separation-anxiety>

3. RSPCA - How to train your dog to stay home alone

Use gradual alone-time training and periodic video checks for hidden signs such as pacing, trembling or quiet whining.

<https://www.rspca.org.uk/adviceandwelfare/pets/dogs/training/leftalone>

4. Blue Cross - Preventing separation anxiety in puppies

Move at the puppy's pace and return to the last comfortable duration whenever worry appears.

<https://www.bluecross.org.uk/advice/dog/behaviour-and-training/preventing-separation-anxiety-in-puppies>

5. RSPCA - Keeping dogs outside

Outdoor time requires shelter, water, security and protection from weather, loneliness and distress.

<https://www.rspca.org.uk/adviceandwelfare/pets/dogs/environment/livingoutside>

6. RSPCA - Caring for dogs in hot weather

Dogs need constant access to shade and clean water in warm weather.

<https://www.rspca.org.uk/adviceandwelfare/seasonal/summer/dogs>